

What is DTP Software?

Desktop publishing (DTP) software is designed for creating visual communications such as brochures, business cards, greeting cards, web pages, posters, and more for professional or personal printing online or on-screen.

Common Examples of DTP Software

1. Adobe FrameMaker
2. Adobe PageMaker
3. Adobe InDesign
4. Corel Ventura
5. CorelDraw
6. LibreOffice Draw
7. Microsoft Publisher
8. Page Stream
9. QuarkXPress

Importance of Desktop Publishing

- **Professional Document Design:** Allows users to create documents with high design sophistication by combining text, images, graphics, and layouts effectively.
- **Enhanced Visual Communication:** Provides powerful features like font selection, image manipulation, and custom layouts to clearly capture audience attention.
- **Customization and Flexibility:** Allows extensive customization of layouts, typography, and graphics using templates or entirely custom designs.
- **Improved Efficiency and Productivity:** Automates repetitive tasks using master pages, templates, and styles to speed up multi-page production.
- **Cost-Effective:** Offers small businesses and freelancers professional-level design tools without the need for expensive graphic design agencies.
- **Integration with Other Software:** Seamlessly incorporates images, data, and text from word processors, spreadsheets, and photo editing tools.

Creating a New Publication from a Template

1. **Open Backstage View:** Click the **File** tab and select **New**. The *Available Templates* pane will appear.
2. **Select Publication Type:** Choose the type of publication you wish to create.
3. **Choose Category:** Templates appear under categories, including *Installed templates* created by Microsoft.
4. **Preview & Modify:** A preview of the selected template appears on the right pane, where you can modify template options (such as color/font schemes).
5. **Finalize:** Click **Create** once satisfied.

Saving Your Document

- **Process:** Click **File**
 - Select **Save As**
 - Type a document name
 - Specify the storage location
 - Click **Save**.
- **Save vs. Save As:**
 - **Save:** Updates the current content of an existing, previously saved file.
 - **Save As:** Used to save an existing file to a new location with either the same or a different title, or to create a new folder.

Basic Publisher Ribbons & Tabs

- **Home (Default Ribbon):** Contains basic text editing tools such as Bold, Italics, alignment, indenting, and fonts. It grants limited control over layout objects.
- **Insert:** Used to add content like pictures, shapes, calendars, borders, page placeholders, and hyperlinks.

- **Page Design:** Allows users to change publication colors, templates, fonts, and page setup options like orientation and margins.
- **Mailings:** Used to mail merge publications and send them out, typically via MS Outlook.
- **Review:** Provides tools for proofing, including checking spelling errors, language translation, and using a thesaurus.
- **View:** Allows users to toggle single- or two-page layouts, add guides/rulers, and cascade windows.

Changing Page Orientation

1. Select the **Page Design** tab.
2. In the *Page Setup* group, click the **Orientation** drop-down menu.
3. Choose either **Portrait** (taller than wide) or **Landscape** (wider than tall).

Changing Page Margins

- **Global Change (All Pages & Master Pages):**
 - Go to **Page Design**
 - Click on **Margins**
 - Select a pre-designed option (*Wide, Moderate, Narrow, or None*).
 - **Specific Change (Single Master Page):**
 - Go to **Page Design**
 - **Click on Master Pages**
 - Click on **Edit Master Pages**.
2. Select the Master Page from the *Page Navigation* pane.
 3. Click **Margins**, then choose **Custom Margins** to enter specific layout values.

Adding and Modifying Pictures

- **Illustration Tools (Insert Tab):**
 - *Pictures:* Insert images from your computer.
 - *Online Pictures:* Find and insert images from internet sources.
 - *Picture Placeholder:* Inserts an empty frame to reserve space to add pictures later.
- **Modifying Options:** Once inserted, pictures can be adjusted via the **Format** tab by *Re-sizing, Cropping, Color correction, adding a Border, or adding a Tint*.

Working with Text & Typography

Adding and Linking Text Boxes

1. **Add:**
 - Click **Home**
 - **Draw Text Box**
 - Drag the cross-shaped cursor to draw the frame
 - Type text.
2. **Link (for text overflow):**
 - Select the box click **Text Box Tools Format** tab
 - Locate the *Linking* group
 - Click **Create Link**
 - Click the spot on your publication where you want the connected text box to appear.

Text Fit Options

Located under the *Text Box Tools Format* tab via the **Text Fit** drop-down menu:

1. **Best Fit:** Automatically adjusts text larger or smaller to fit the box perfectly.
2. **Shrink Text on Overflow:** Automatically shrinks the font size when the box runs out of room.
3. **Grow Text Box to Fit:** Automatically enlarges the text box size based on text length (**Default option**).
4. **Do not Autofit:** Makes no automatic adjustments to text or box size.

Typography Commands (Enhancing Text)

Found under **Text Box Tools Format** tab, **Typography** group. Best supported by fonts like *Calibri, Cambria, and Gabriola*:

- **Drop Cap:** Enlarges the first letter of selected text.

- **Number Style:** Offers four different styles for number spacing and alignment.
- **Ligatures:** Connect specific letter combinations to enhance readability.
- **Stylistic Sets:** Adds various font embellishments, typically exaggerated serifs or flourishes.
- **Swash:** Embellishes capital letters.
- **Stylistic Alternates:** Provides alternate versions of specific lowercase letters (e.g., the letter 'g').

Designing a Flyer

1. On the start screen, select **New**.
2. Click on a flyer template's thumbnail image to open it.
3. Use workspace tools to **Add Text and Images**.
4. **Format the Layout** using contextual tools.
5. **Save/Print** the finalized flyer design.